Week 14 Progress Report

Details

- **Name of Student:** Tirthak Girish Likhar
- **PRN:** 22070521041
- **Name of Industry:** SS Infotech Pvt. Ltd.
- **Reporting Week: (06/04/2026 to 10/04/2026)**
- **Institute Mentor Name:** Dr. Shreyas Hole
- **Industry Mentor Name:** Mr. Viraj Patle

Overview of the Week

- Week 14 focused on implementing and validating Wazuh Active Response — a core incident response feature that enables the SIEM to automatically take defensive action when a threat is detected, without any manual intervention. This moved the SOC lab beyond passive detection into active, automated defense, replicating real-world SOC automation workflows.

- The active response was configured by adding a firewall-drop block to the Wazuh Manager's ossec.conf file, tied to Rule 5763 (SSH Brute Force detection, Level 10). With this configuration, any time Wazuh detects an SSH brute force attack from a source IP, it automatically executes an iptables DROP rule on the Ubuntu Server to block all traffic from the attacker IP for 180 seconds. The configuration was added using the sudo sed command to avoid manual editing issues.

- To test the active response, an SSH brute force attack was launched from the Ubuntu 22.04 attacker VM (192.168.1.7) using Hydra v9.5 with a custom password wordlist against the Wazuh Server (192.168.1.6). Wazuh detected the attack via Rule 5763, and the active response module automatically executed the firewall-drop command, adding a DROP rule for 192.168.1.7 in iptables. The block was verified using iptables and the active-responses.log file, and subsequently removed after verification to restore lab connectivity.

Objectives of the Week

- **To configure Wazuh Active Response by adding a firewall-drop command block tied to Rule 5763 in ossec.conf on the Wazuh Manager.**
- **To set a 180-second automatic IP block timeout and verify the configuration was correctly written to ossec.conf.**
- **To restart the Wazuh Manager service and confirm successful loading of the active response configuration.**
- **To simulate an SSH Brute Force attack from the Ubuntu 22.04 attacker VM (192.168.1.7) using Hydra v9.5 to trigger Rule 5763.**
- **To verify that Wazuh Active Response automatically executed a firewall-drop rule and blocked the attacker IP (192.168.1.7) in iptables without any manual intervention.**
- **To confirm the active response action in the Wazuh active-responses.log and on the Wazuh Security Events dashboard.**
- **To demonstrate end-to-end automated incident response — from attack detection to automatic IP block — within the simulated SOC environment.**

Key Accomplishments

- Successfully configured Wazuh Active Response in **ossec.conf** by adding a firewall-drop command block tied to Rule 5763 with a 180-second timeout, using sudo sed for precise file modification.

- Restarted the Wazuh Manager service and confirmed active status using systemctl, verifying the new active response configuration was loaded without errors.
- Executed SSH Brute Force attack from the Ubuntu 22.04 attacker VM (192.168.1.7) using **Hydra v9.5** with a custom password wordlist targeting the Wazuh Server SSH service at 192.168.1.6 — 8 failed attempts completed in approximately 39 seconds.
- Wazuh detected the brute force attack via **Rule 5763 (Level 10)** and automatically triggered the firewall-drop active response without any manual intervention.
- Verified automatic IP block by running **sudo iptables -L INPUT -n | grep 192.168.1** on the Ubuntu Server — confirmed DROP rule for attacker IP 192.168.1.7.
- Confirmed active response execution in **/var/ossec/logs/active-responses.log** showing the firewall-drop command was executed against 192.168.1.7.
- Verified Rule 5763 alert on the Wazuh Security Events dashboard — source IP 192.168.1.7, MITRE T1110 (Brute Force), Credential Access tactic, compliance tags GDPR, HIPAA, PCI-DSS, NIST 800-53 all confirmed.
- Removed the iptables block after verification using **sudo iptables -D INPUT -s 192.168.1.7 -j DROP** to restore lab network connectivity for future simulations.

Issues Faced & Resolutions – Week 14

- **1. Editing ossec.conf to add the active response block**

  Issue: When attempting to manually navigate to the end of the ossec.conf file in nano and insert the active response XML block just before the closing </ossec_config> tag, the large size of the file and terminal navigation limitations made manual editing error-prone.

  Resolution: Used the sudo sed command to automatically locate the </ossec_config> closing tag and insert the complete active response XML block just before it in a single command. The change was verified using sudo tail -15 /var/ossec/etc/ossec.conf to confirm the block was correctly added before restarting the Wazuh Manager.

- **2. Confirming the active response fired vs just the detection alert**

  Issue: After running Hydra and seeing the Rule 5763 alert appear on the Wazuh Dashboard, it was necessary to independently verify that the active response module had actually executed the firewall-drop command and added the iptables rule, rather than just relying on the dashboard alert alone.

  Resolution: Ran sudo iptables -L INPUT -n | grep 192.168.1 on the Ubuntu Server immediately after the Hydra run. The output confirmed a DROP rule for 192.168.1.7, validating that the active response fired. Additionally checked /var/ossec/logs/active-responses.log to confirm the firewall-drop command execution was logged by Wazuh.

Tools Used – Week 14

- **Wazuh Manager (Ubuntu Server 24.04, ossec.conf)** — Platform used to configure the active response firewall-drop command tied to Rule 5763 with a 180-second timeout.
- **Hydra v9.5 (Ubuntu 22.04 Attacker VM)** — Used to simulate the SSH Brute Force attack from 192.168.1.7 against the Wazuh Server at 192.168.1.6 to trigger Rule 5763 and the active response.
- **iptables (Ubuntu Server 24.04)** — Used by Wazuh's firewall-drop active response to automatically add the DROP rule for the attacker IP. Also used manually to verify and later remove the block.
- **Wazuh Dashboard (v4.7.5)** — Used to verify the Rule 5763 brute force alert, MITRE tagging, source IP attribution, and compliance framework tags.
- **Active Responses Log (/var/ossec/logs/active-responses.log)** — Used to confirm that the firewall-drop command was executed by Wazuh's active response module.
- **VirtualBox** — Hypervisor hosting the Ubuntu Server and attacker VM on the internal network.

Conclusion of Week 14

Week 14 marked a significant advancement in the SOC lab by implementing automated incident response — the most operationally impactful feature demonstrated in the project so far. By configuring Wazuh's firewall-drop active response tied to Rule 5763, the lab now performs a complete detect-and-respond cycle autonomously: the moment an SSH brute force attack is detected, the attacker's IP is automatically dropped at the firewall level without any analyst intervention. This mirrors how enterprise SOCs use SOAR (Security Orchestration, Automation and Response) platforms to reduce response time from minutes to seconds. The verification process — cross-checking the iptables DROP rule and the active-responses.log alongside the Wazuh dashboard alert — demonstrated rigorous incident validation methodology. The lab environment now has five fully functional components: threat detection, attack simulation, file integrity monitoring, custom rule authoring, and automated active response.

Active Response Configuration – Week 14

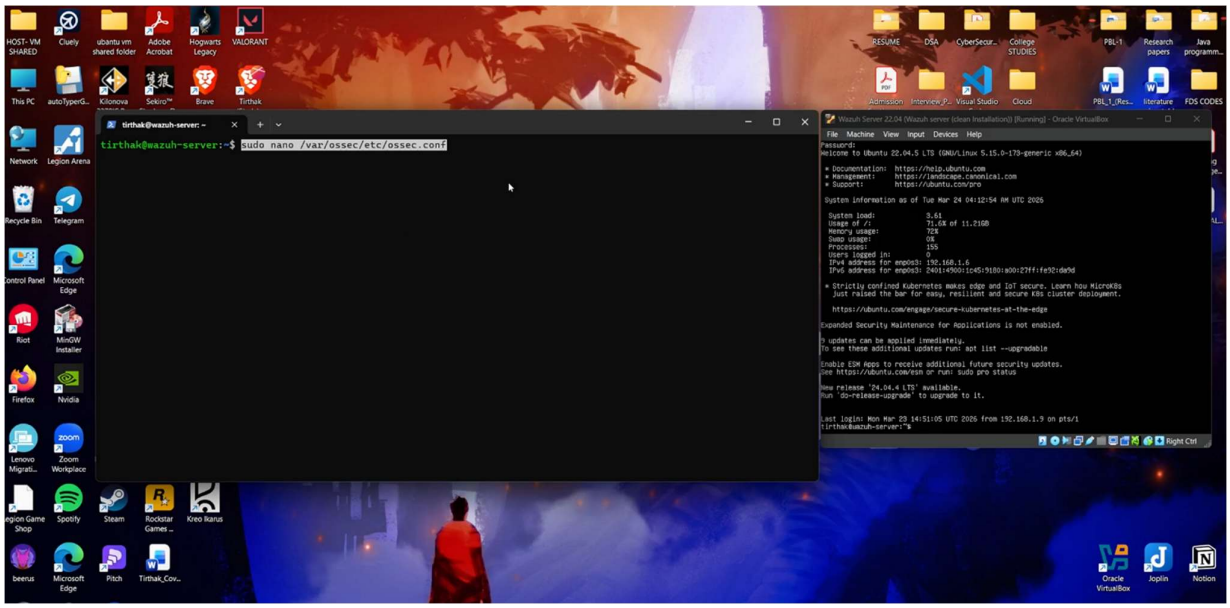
Parameter	Value
Command	firewall-drop
Location	local (Wazuh Server)
Trigger Rule	5763 (SSH Brute Force, Level 10)
Timeout	180 seconds
Config File	/var/ossec/etc/ossec.conf
Action	iptables DROP rule added for attacker IP
Log File	/var/ossec/logs/active-responses.log

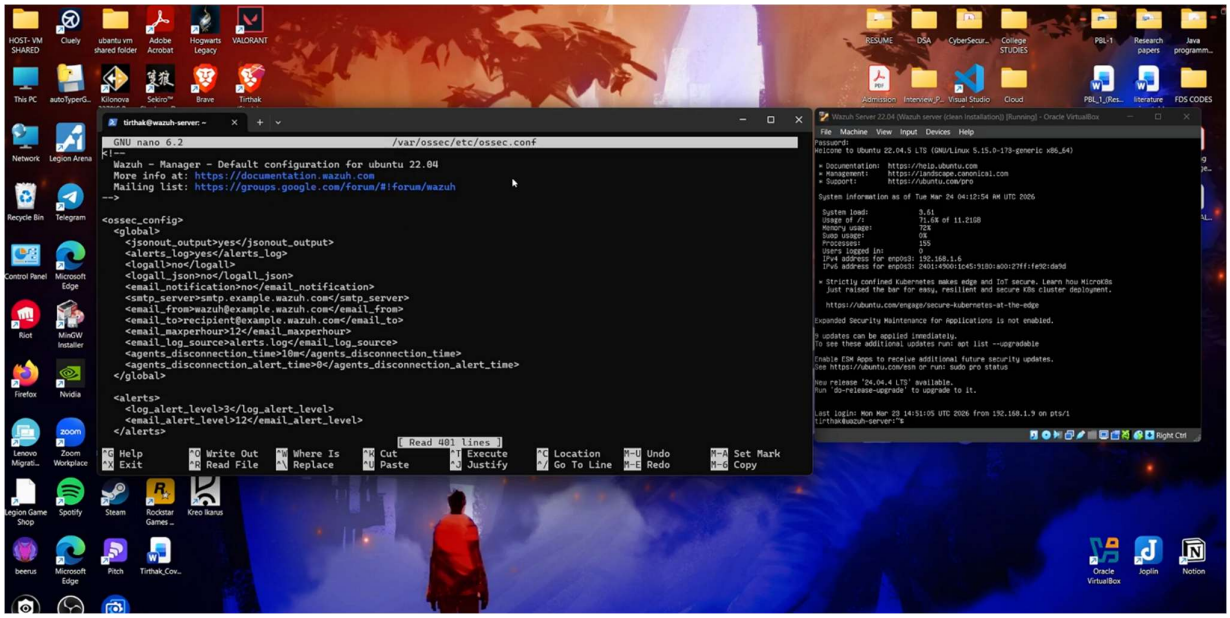
Rule 5763 Alert Details – Triggering Alert:

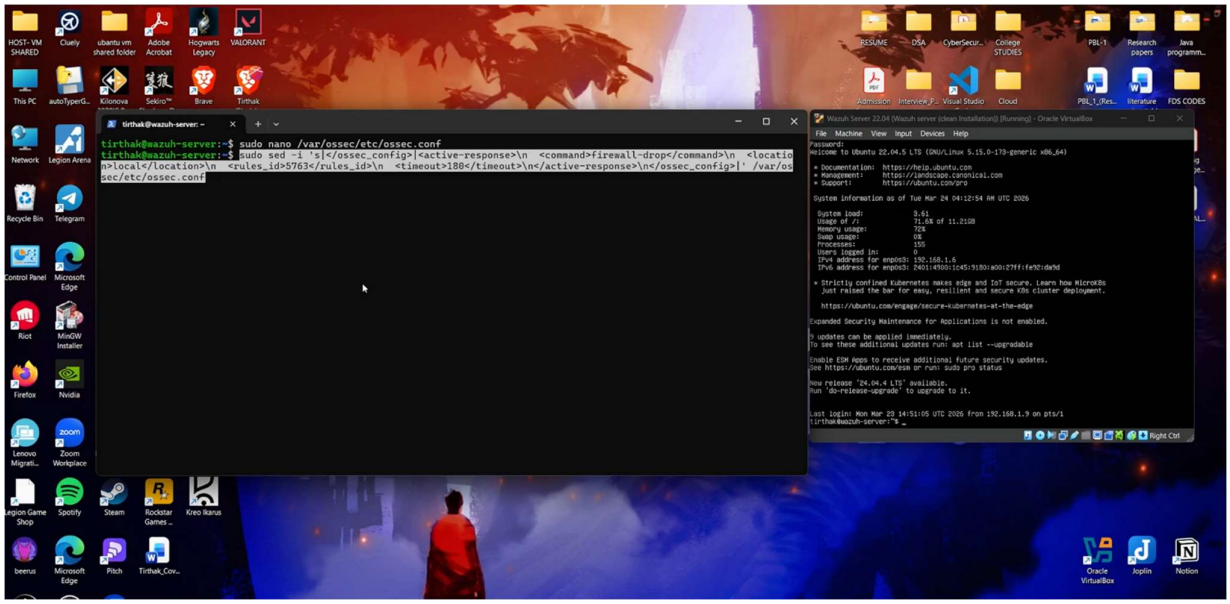
Field	Value
Rule ID	5763
Rule Level	10 (High)
Description	sshd: brute force trying to get access to the system. Authentication failed.
Source IP	192.168.1.7 (Attacker VM)
Target	192.168.1.6 (Wazuh Server SSH)
MITRE ID	T1110
MITRE Technique	Brute Force
MITRE Tactic	Credential Access
Compliance — GDPR	IV_35.7.d, IV_32.2
Compliance — HIPAA	164.312.b
Compliance — PCI-DSS	11.4, 10.2.4, 10.2.5
Compliance — NIST 800-53	SI.4, AU.14, AC.7
Active Response Action	firewall-drop — DROP rule added for 192.168.1.7

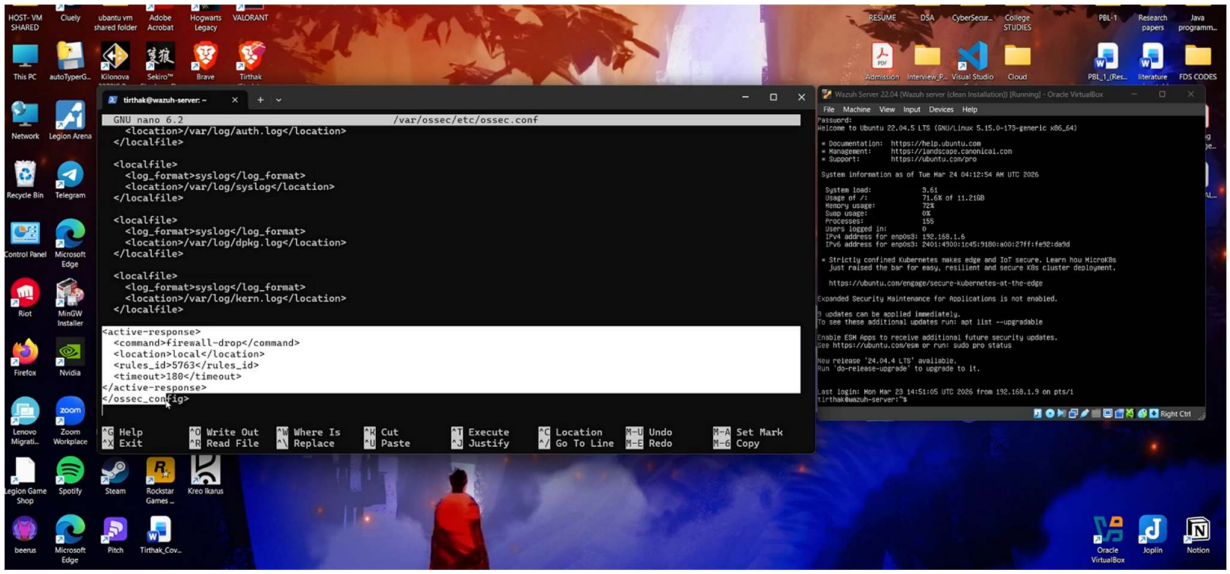
Screenshots of Activities (if Any)

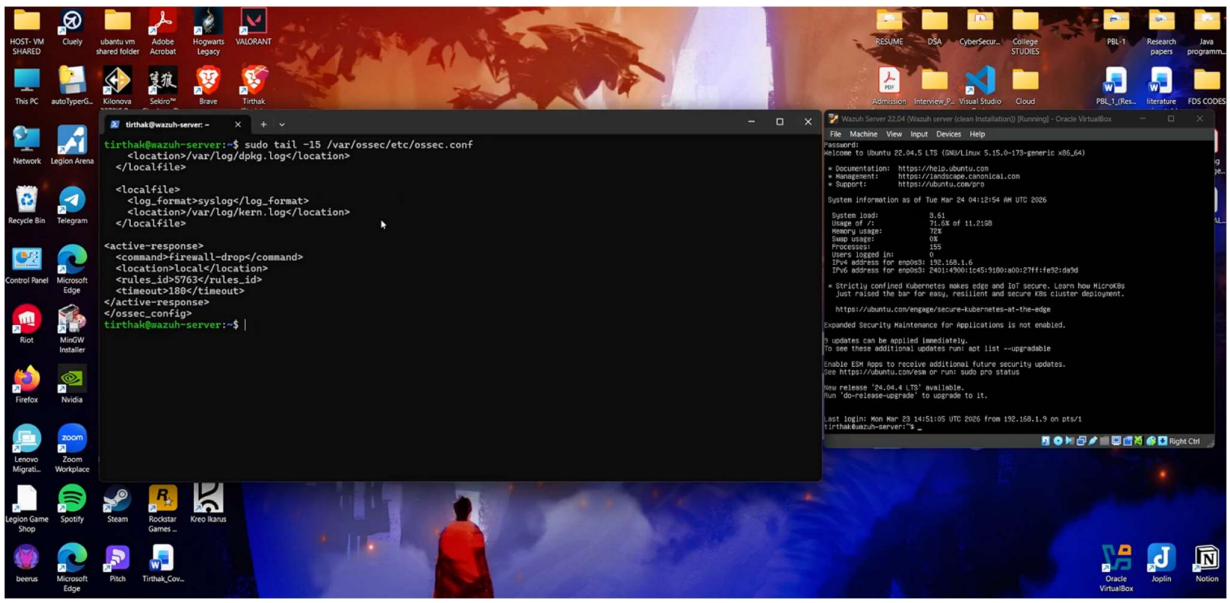
[Please insert screenshots here — ossec.conf active response block, Wazuh Manager restart confirmation, Hydra attack terminal output, Rule 5763 alert on Wazuh Dashboard, iptables DROP rule showing 192.168.1.7, active-responses.log showing firewall-drop execution]






tirthak@wazuh-server: ~
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$ sudo nano /var/ossec/etc/ossec.conf
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$ sudo sed -i 's|</ossec_config>|<active-response>\n <command>firewall-drop</command>\n <location>local</location>\n <rules_id>5763</rules_id>\n <timeout>180</timeout>\n</active-response>\n</ossec_config>|' /var/ossec/etc/ossec.conf
Wazuh Server 22.04 (Wazuh server (clean Installation)) [Running] - Oracle VirtualBox
File Machine View Input Devices Help
Welcome to Ubuntu 22.04.5 LTS (GNU/Linux 5.15.0-173-generic x86_64)
* Documentation: https://help.ubuntu.com
* Management: https://landscape.canonical.com
* Support: https://ubuntu.com/pro
System information as of Tue Mar 24 04:12:54 AM UTC 2026
System load: 3.61
Usage of /: 71.6% of 11.21GB
Memory usage: 72%
Swap usage: 0%
Processes: 155
Users logged in: 0
IPv4 address for enp0s3: 192.168.1.6
IPv6 address for enp0s3: 2401:4900:1c45:9180:a00:27ff:fe92:da9d
* Strictly confined Kubernetes makes edge and IoT secure. Learn how MicroK8s just raised the bar for easy, resilient and secure K8s cluster deployment.
https://ubuntu.com/engage/secure-kubernetes-at-the-edge
Expanded Security Maintenance for Applications is not enabled.
9 updates can be applied immediately.
To see these additional updates run: apt list --upgradable
Enable ESM Apps to receive additional future security updates.
See https://ubuntu.com/esm or run: sudo pro status
New release '24.04.4 LTS' available.
Run 'do-release-upgrade' to upgrade to it.
Last login: Mon Mar 23 14:51:05 UTC 2026 from 192.168.1.9 on pts/1
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$


tirthak@wazuh-server: ~
GNU nano 6.2 /var/ossec/etc/ossec.conf
<location>/var/log/auth.log</location>
</localfile>
<localfile>
<log_format>syslog</log_format>
<location>/var/log/syslog</location>
</localfile>
<localfile>
<log_format>syslog</log_format>
<location>/var/log/dpkg.log</location>
</localfile>
<localfile>
<log_format>syslog</log_format>
<location>/var/log/kern.log</location>
</localfile>
<active-response>
<command>firewall-drop</command>
<location>local</location>
<rules_id>5763</rules_id>
<timeout>180</timeout>
</active-response>
</ossec_config>
^G Help ^O Write Out ^W Where Is ^K Cut ^T Execute ^C Location M-U Undo M-A Set Mark
^X Exit ^R Read File ^\ Replace ^U Paste ^J Justify ^/ Go To Line M-E Redo M-6 Copy
Wazuh Server 22.04 (Wazuh server (clean Installation)) [Running] - Oracle VirtualBox
File Machine View Input Devices Help


tirthak@wazuh-server: ~
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$ sudo tail -15 /var/ossec/etc/ossec.conf
<location>/var/log/dpkg.log</location>
</localfile>
<localfile>
<log_format>syslog</log_format>
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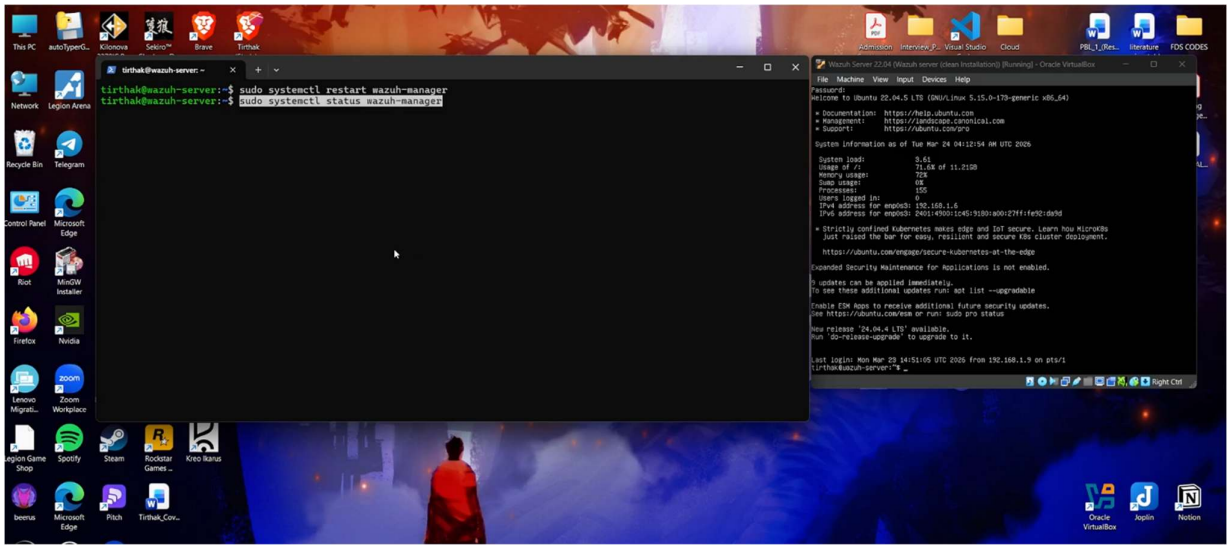
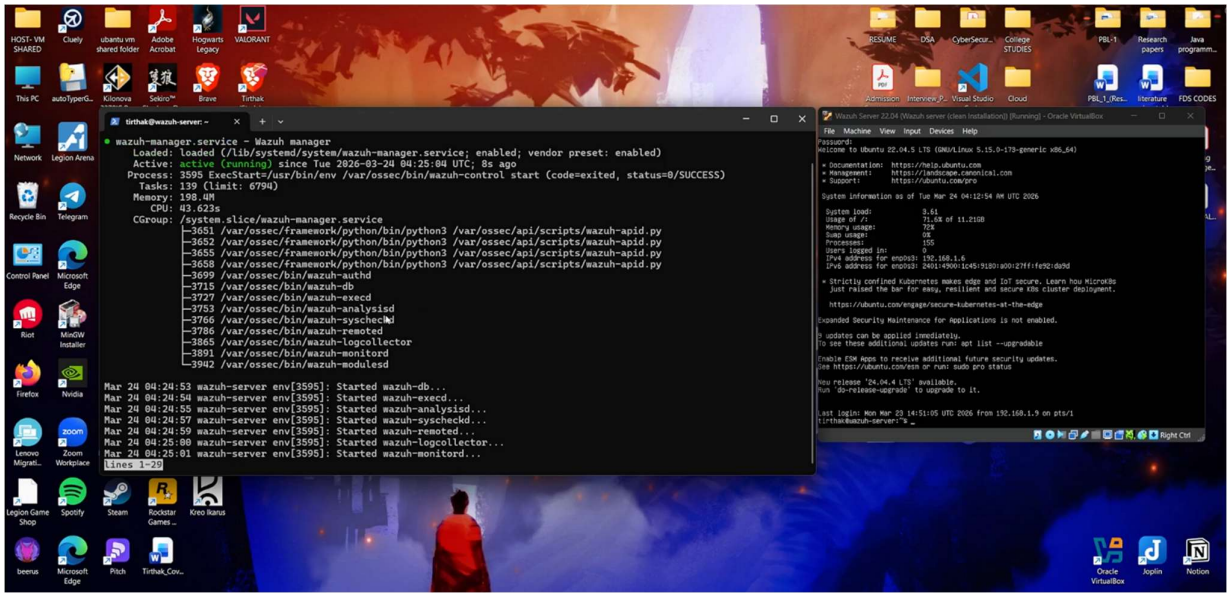
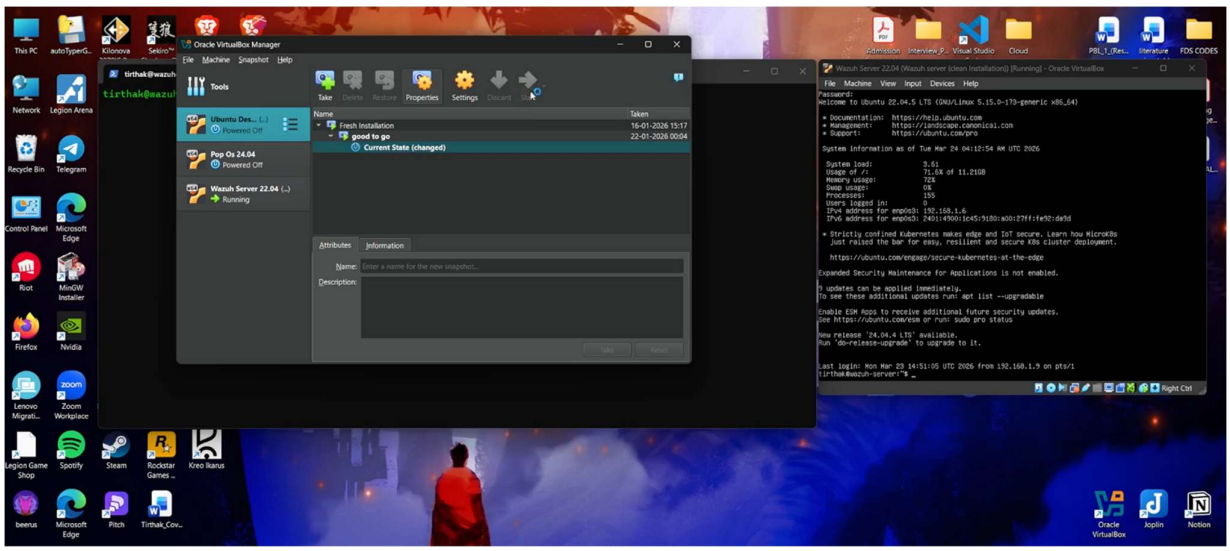
<timeout>180</timeout>
</active-response>
</ossec_config>
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$


tirthak@wazuh-server: ~
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$ sudo systemctl restart wazuh-manager
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$ sudo systemctl status wazuh-manager


tirthak@wazuh-server: ~
● wazuh-manager.service - Wazuh manager
Loaded: loaded (/lib/systemd/system/wazuh-manager.service; enabled; vendor preset: enabled)
Active: active (running) since Tue 2026-03-24 04:25:04 UTC; 8s ago
Process: 3595 ExecStart=/usr/bin/env /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-control start (code=exited, status=0/SUCCESS)
Tasks: 139 (limit: 6794)
Memory: 198.4M
CPU: 43.623s
CGroup: /system.slice/wazuh-manager.service
├3651 /var/ossec/framework/python/bin/python3 /var/ossec/api/scripts/wazuh-apid.py
├3652 /var/ossec/framework/python/bin/python3 /var/ossec/api/scripts/wazuh-apid.py
├3655 /var/ossec/framework/python/bin/python3 /var/ossec/api/scripts/wazuh-apid.py
├3658 /var/ossec/framework/python/bin/python3 /var/ossec/api/scripts/wazuh-apid.py
├3699 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-authd
├3715 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-db
├3727 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-execd
├3753 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-analysisd
├3766 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-syscheckd
├3786 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-remoted
├3865 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-logcollector
├3891 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-monitord
└3942 /var/ossec/bin/wazuh-modulesd
Mar 24 04:24:53 wazuh-server env[3595]: Started wazuh-db...
Mar 24 04:24:54 wazuh-server env[3595]: Started wazuh-execd...
Mar 24 04:24:55 wazuh-server env[3595]: Started wazuh-analysisd...
Mar 24 04:24:57 wazuh-server env[3595]: Started wazuh-syscheckd...
Mar 24 04:24:59 wazuh-server env[3595]: Started wazuh-remoted...
Mar 24 04:25:00 wazuh-server env[3595]: Started wazuh-logcollector...
Mar 24 04:25:01 wazuh-server env[3595]: Started wazuh-monitord...
lines 1-29


Oracle VirtualBox Manager
File Machine Snapshot Help
Tools
Take Delete Restore Properties Settings Discard Show
Ubuntu Des... (...)
Powered Off
Pop Os 24.04
Powered Off
Wazuh Server 22.04 (...)
Running
Name
Taken
Fresh Installation
16-01-2026 15:17
good to go
22-01-2026 00:04
Current State (changed)
Attributes
Information
Name:
Description:
Wazuh Server 22.04 (Wazuh server (clean installation)) [Running] - Oracle VirtualBox
File Machine View Input Devices Help
Password:
Welcome to Ubuntu 22.04.5 LTS (GNU/Linux 5.15.0-173-generic x86_64)
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System load: 3.61
Usage of /: 71.6% of 11.21GB
Memory usage: 72%
Swap usage: 0%
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Run 'do-release-upgrade' to upgrade to it.
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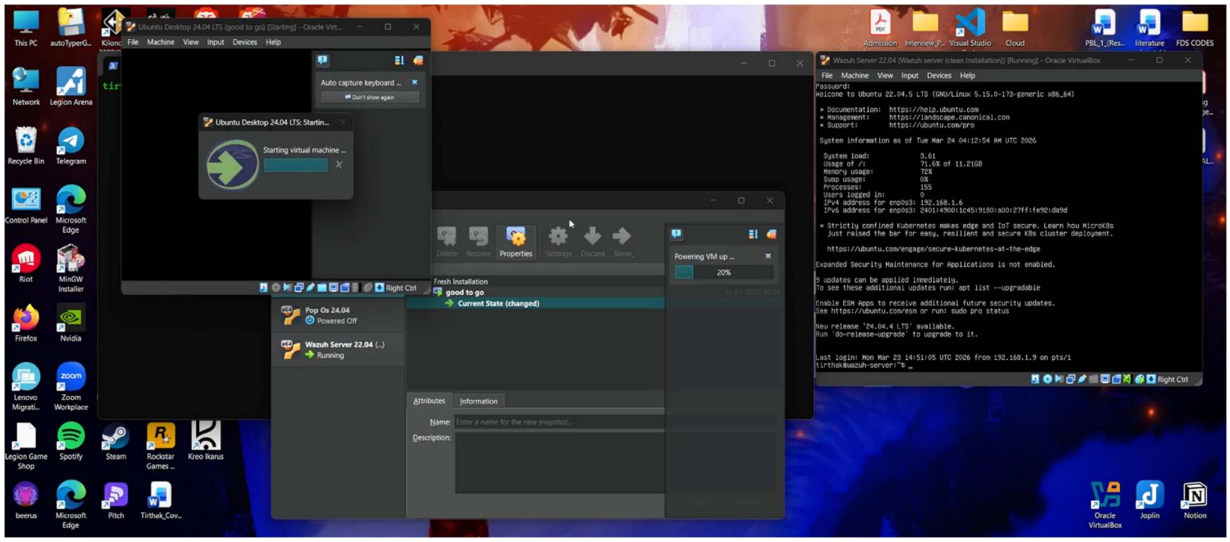
Right Ctrl


Ubuntu Desktop 24.04 LTS (good to go) [Starting] - Oracle Virt...
File Machine View Input Devices Help
Auto capture keyboard ...
Don't show again
Ubuntu Desktop 24.04 LTS: Startin...
Starting virtual machine ...
Delete Restore Properties Settings Discard Show
Powering VM up ...
20%
Fresh Installation
good to go
Current State (changed)
Pop Os 24.04
Powered Off
Wazuh Server 22.04 (...)
Running
Attributes
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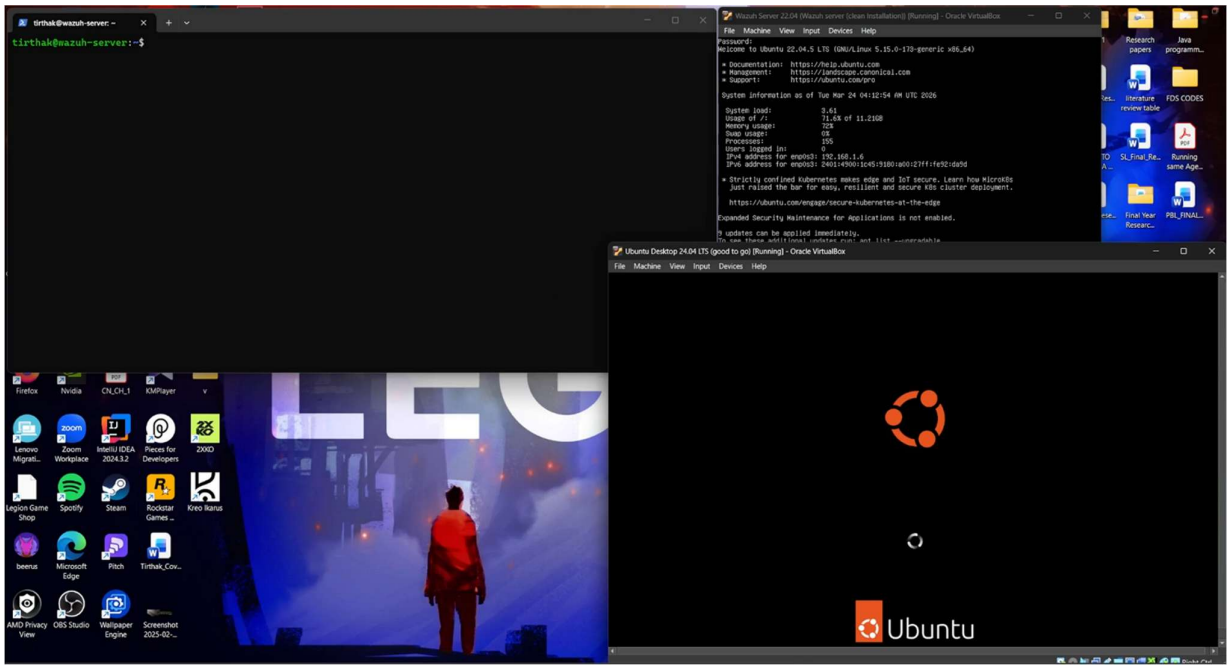
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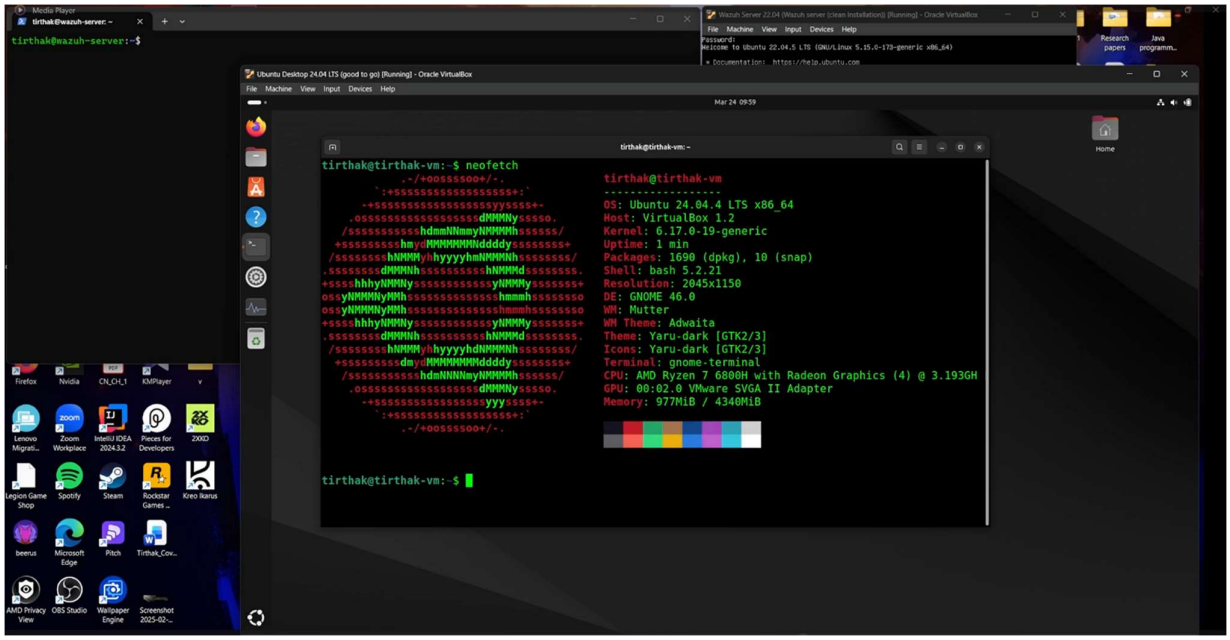
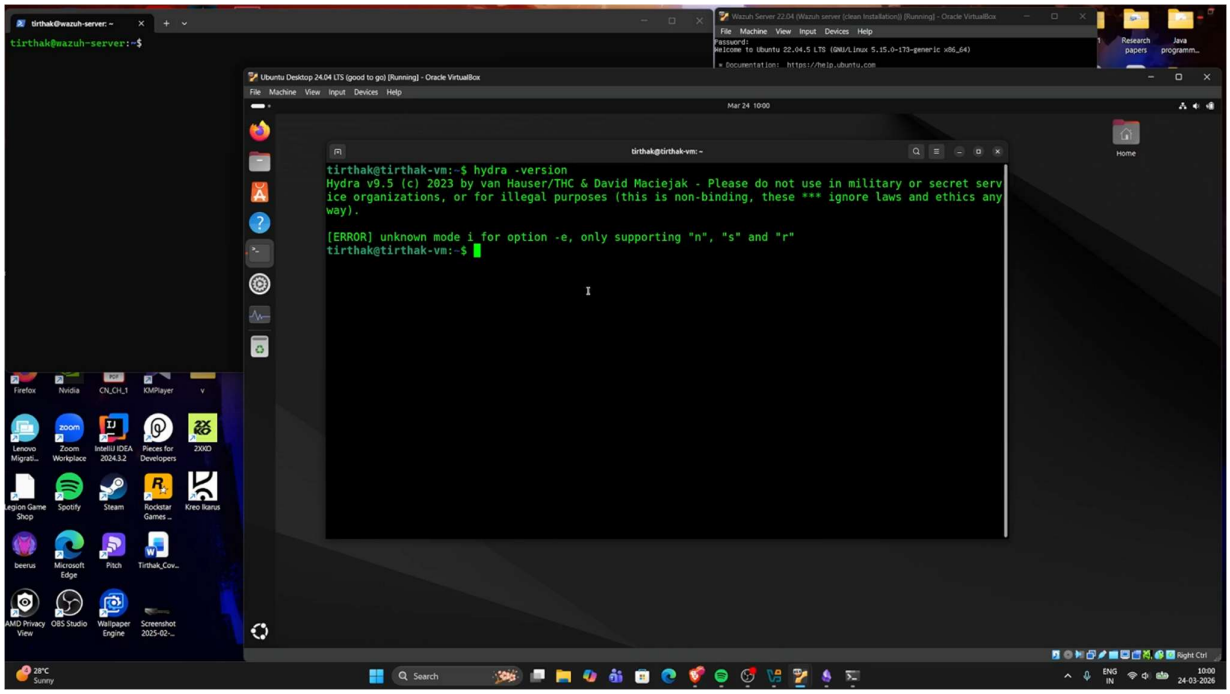
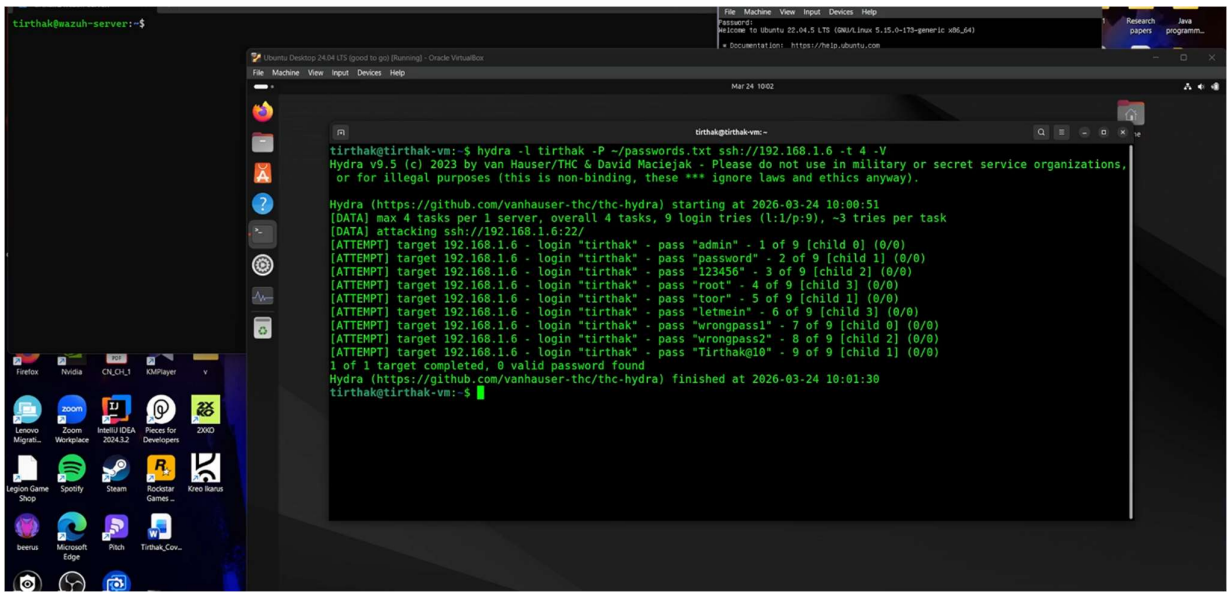
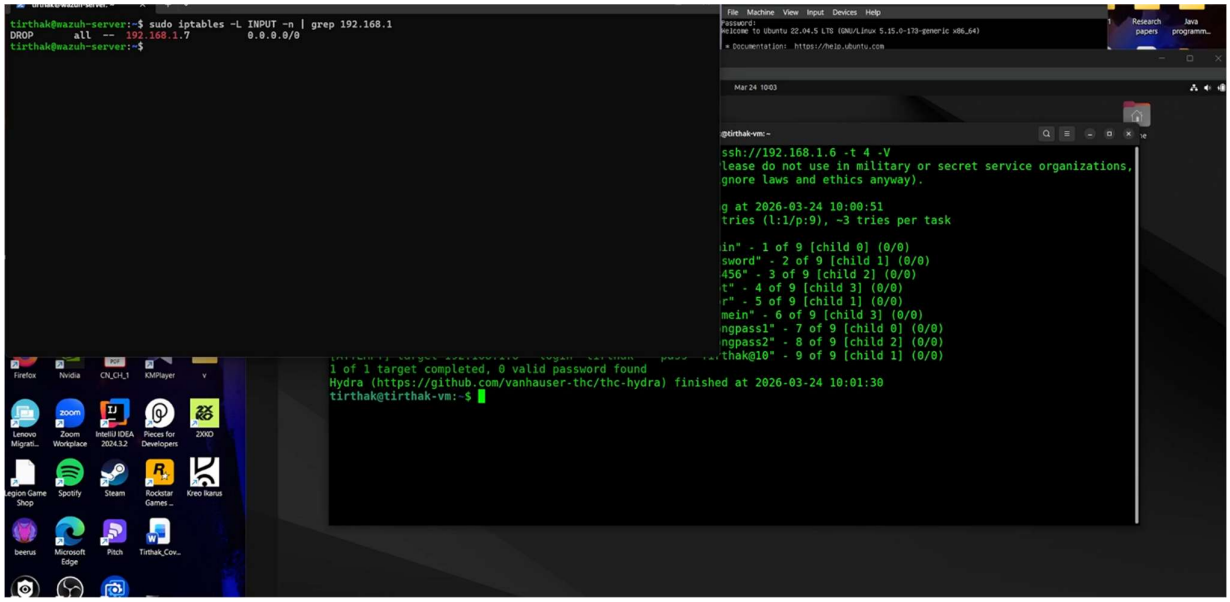
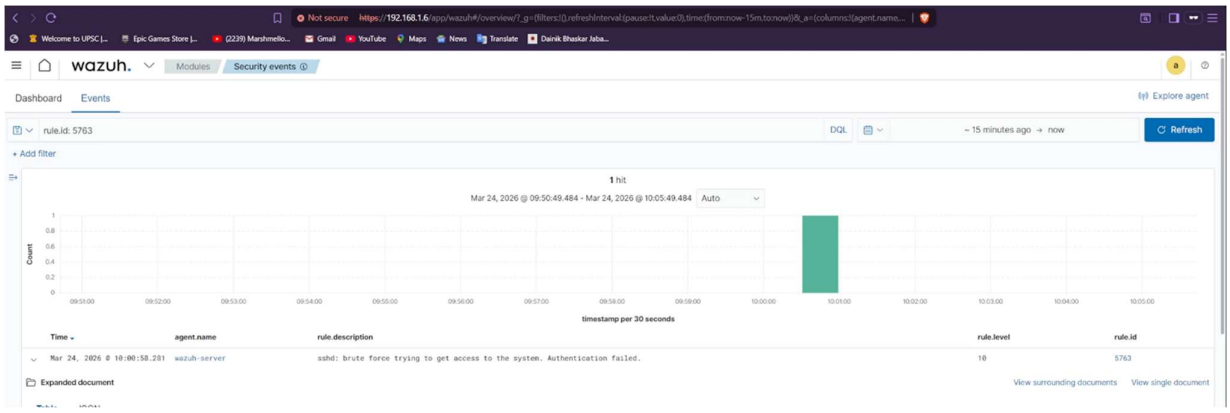
Just raised the bar for easy, resilient and secure K8s cluster deployment.
https://ubuntu.com/engage/secure-kubernetes-at-the-edge
Expanded Security Maintenance for Applications is not enabled.
Ubuntu Desktop 24.04 LTS (good to go) [Running] - Oracle VirtualBox
File Machine View Input Devices Help
Ubuntu

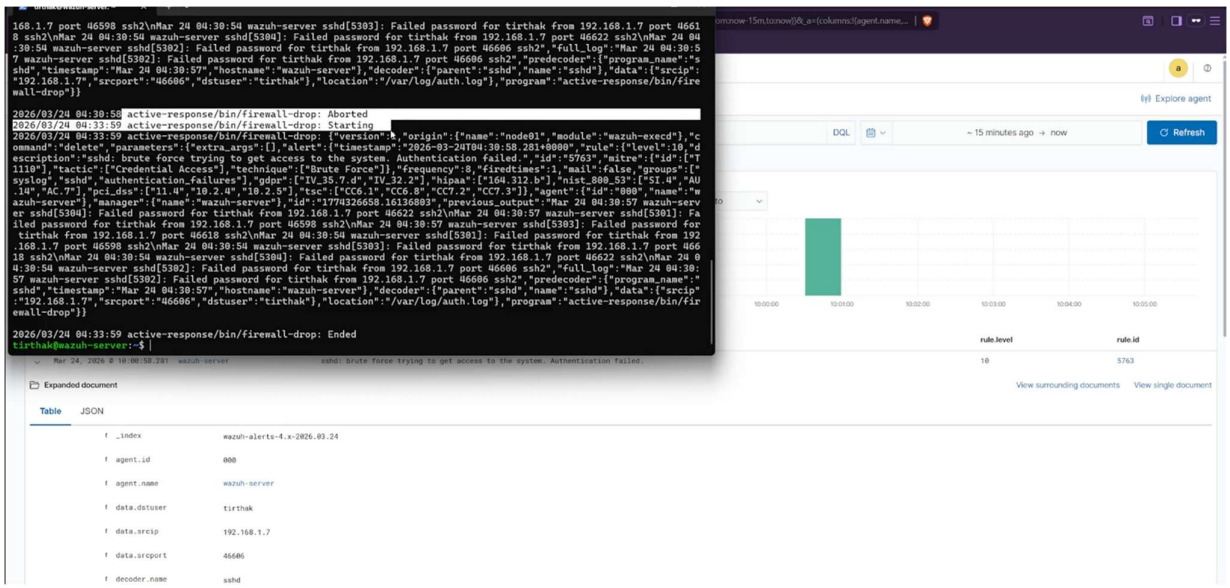

tirthak@wazuh-server: ~
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$
Ubuntu Desktop 24.04 LTS (good to go) [Running] - Oracle VirtualBox
File Machine View Input Devices Help
Mar 24 09:59
tirthak@tirthak-vm: ~
tirthak@tirthak-vm:~$ neofetch
tirthak@tirthak-vm
OS: Ubuntu 24.04.4 LTS x86_64
Host: VirtualBox 1.2
Kernel: 6.17.0-19-generic
Uptime: 1 min
Packages: 1690 (dpkg), 10 (snap)
Shell: bash 5.2.21
Resolution: 2045x1150
DE: GNOME 46.0
WM: Mutter
WM Theme: Adwaita
Theme: Yaru-dark [GTK2/3]
Icons: Yaru-dark [GTK2/3]
Terminal: gnome-terminal
CPU: AMD Ryzen 7 6800H with Radeon Graphics (4) @ 3.193GH
GPU: 00:02.0 VMware SVGA II Adapter
Memory: 977MiB / 4340MiB
tirthak@tirthak-vm:~$

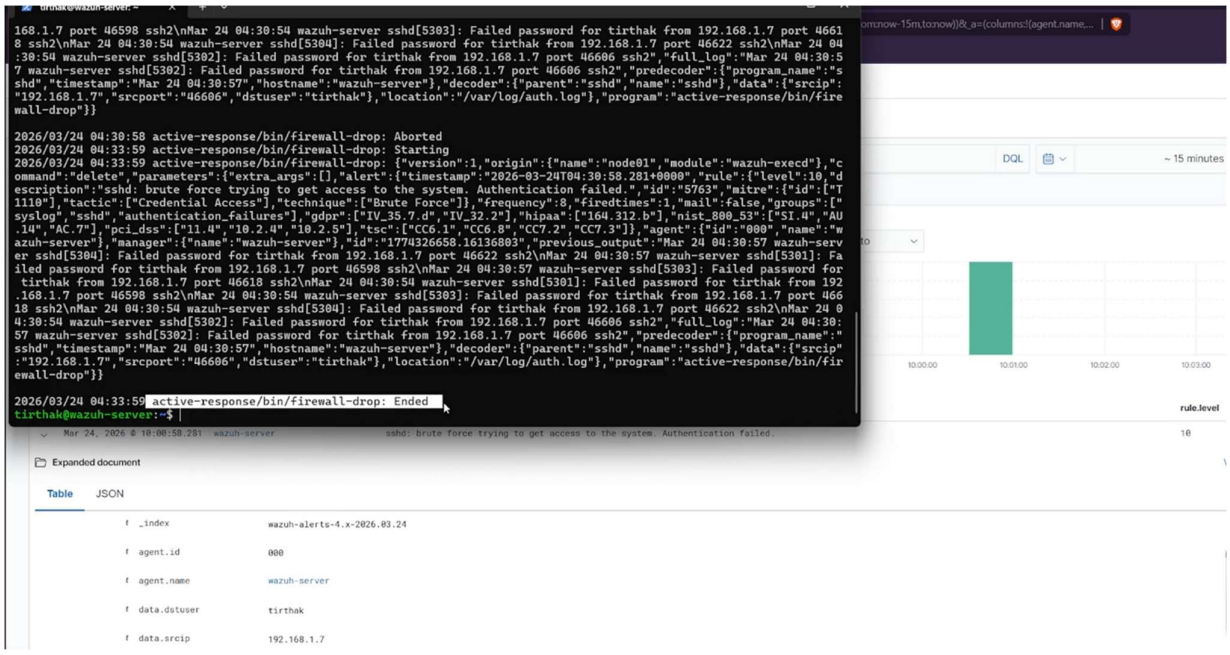

tirthak@wazuh-server: ~
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$
Ubuntu Desktop 24.04 LTS (good to go) [Running] - Oracle VirtualBox
File Machine View Input Devices Help
Mar 24 10:00
tirthak@tirthak-vm: ~
tirthak@tirthak-vm:~$ hydra -version
Hydra v9.5 (c) 2023 by van Hauser/THC & David Maciejak - Please do not use in military or secret service organizations, or for illegal purposes (this is non-binding, these *** ignore laws and ethics anyway).
[ERROR] unknown mode i for option -e, only supporting "n", "s" and "r"
tirthak@tirthak-vm:~$


tirthak@wazuh-server:~$
tirthak@tirthak-vm: ~
tirthak@tirthak-vm:~$ hydra -l tirthak -P ~/passwords.txt ssh://192.168.1.6 -t 4 -V
Hydra v9.5 (c) 2023 by van Hauser/THC & David Maciejak - Please do not use in military or secret service organizations,
or for illegal purposes (this is non-binding, these *** ignore laws and ethics anyway).
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) starting at 2026-03-24 10:00:51
[DATA] max 4 tasks per 1 server, overall 4 tasks, 9 login tries (l:1/p:9), ~3 tries per task
[DATA] attacking ssh://192.168.1.6:22/
[ATTEMPT] target 192.168.1.6 - login "tirthak" - pass "admin" - 1 of 9 [child 0] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 192.168.1.6 - login "tirthak" - pass "password" - 2 of 9 [child 1] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 192.168.1.6 - login "tirthak" - pass "123456" - 3 of 9 [child 2] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 192.168.1.6 - login "tirthak" - pass "root" - 4 of 9 [child 3] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 192.168.1.6 - login "tirthak" - pass "toor" - 5 of 9 [child 1] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 192.168.1.6 - login "tirthak" - pass "letmein" - 6 of 9 [child 3] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 192.168.1.6 - login "tirthak" - pass "wrongpass1" - 7 of 9 [child 0] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 192.168.1.6 - login "tirthak" - pass "wrongpass2" - 8 of 9 [child 2] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 192.168.1.6 - login "tirthak" - pass "Tirthak@10" - 9 of 9 [child 1] (0/0)
1 of 1 target completed, 0 valid password found
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) finished at 2026-03-24 10:01:30
tirthak@tirthak-vm:~$


tirthak@wazuh-server:~$ sudo iptables -L INPUT -n | grep 192.168.1
DROP all -- 192.168.1.7 0.0.0.0/0
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$
1 of 1 target completed, 0 valid password found
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) finished at 2026-03-24 10:01:30
tirthak@tirthak-vm:~$


wazuh.
Modules
Security events
Dashboard
Events
Explore agent
rule.id: 5763
DQL
~ 15 minutes ago → now
Refresh
+ Add filter
1 hit
Mar 24, 2026 @ 09:50:49.484 - Mar 24, 2026 @ 10:05:49.484
Auto
Count
timestamp per 30 seconds
Time
agent.name
rule.description
rule.level
rule.id
Mar 24, 2026 @ 10:00:58.281
wazuh-server
sshd: brute force trying to get access to the system. Authentication failed.
10
5763
Expanded document
View surrounding documents
View single document


168.1.7 port 46598 ssh2\nMar 24 04:30:54 wazuh-server sshd[5303]: Failed password for tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 4661
8 ssh2\nMar 24 04:30:54 wazuh-server sshd[5304]: Failed password for tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 46622 ssh2\nMar 24 04
:30:54 wazuh-server sshd[5302]: Failed password for tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 46606 ssh2","full_log":"Mar 24 04:30:5
7 wazuh-server sshd[5302]: Failed password for tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 46606 ssh2","predecoder":{"program_name":"s
shd","timestamp":"Mar 24 04:30:57","hostname":"wazuh-server"},"decoder":{"parent":"sshd","name":"sshd"},"data":{"srcip":
"192.168.1.7","srcport":"46606","dstuser":"tirthak"},"location":"/var/log/auth.log"},"program":"active-response/bin/fire
wall-drop"}}
2026/03/24 04:30:58 active-response/bin/firewall-drop: Aborted
2026/03/24 04:33:59 active-response/bin/firewall-drop: Starting
2026/03/24 04:33:59 active-response/bin/firewall-drop: {"version":1,"origin":{"name":"node01","module":"wazuh-execd"},"c
ommand":"delete","parameters":{"extra_args":[],"alert":{"timestamp":"2026-03-24T04:30:58.281+0000","rule":{"level":10,"d
escription":"sshd: brute force trying to get access to the system. Authentication failed.","id":"5763","mitre":{"id":["T
1110"],"tactic":["Credential Access"],"technique":["Brute Force"]},"frequency":8,"firedtimes":1,"mail":false,"groups":["
syslog","sshd","authentication_failures"],"gdpr":["IV_35.7.d","IV_32.2"],"hipaa":["164.312.b"],"nist_800_53":["SI.4","AU
.14","AC.7"],"pci_dss":["11.4","10.2.4","10.2.5"],"tsc":["CC6.1","CC6.8","CC7.2","CC7.3"]},"agent":{"id":"000","name":"w
azuh-server"},"manager":{"name":"wazuh-server"},"id":"1774326658.16136803","previous_output":"Mar 24 04:30:57 wazuh-serv
er sshd[5304]: Failed password for tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 46622 ssh2\nMar 24 04:30:57 wazuh-server sshd[5301]: Fa
iled password for tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 46598 ssh2\nMar 24 04:30:57 wazuh-server sshd[5303]: Failed password for
tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 46618 ssh2\nMar 24 04:30:54 wazuh-server sshd[5301]: Failed password for tirthak from 192
.168.1.7 port 46598 ssh2\nMar 24 04:30:54 wazuh-server sshd[5303]: Failed password for tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 466
18 ssh2\nMar 24 04:30:54 wazuh-server sshd[5304]: Failed password for tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 46622 ssh2\nMar 24 0
4:30:54 wazuh-server sshd[5302]: Failed password for tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 46606 ssh2","full_log":"Mar 24 04:30:
57 wazuh-server sshd[5302]: Failed password for tirthak from 192.168.1.7 port 46606 ssh2","predecoder":{"program_name":"
sshd","timestamp":"Mar 24 04:30:57","hostname":"wazuh-server"},"decoder":{"parent":"sshd","name":"sshd"},"data":{"srcip"
:"192.168.1.7","srcport":"46606","dstuser":"tirthak"},"location":"/var/log/auth.log"},"program":"active-response/bin/fir
ewall-drop"}}
2026/03/24 04:33:59 active-response/bin/firewall-drop: Ended
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$
Explore agent
DQL
~ 15 minutes ago → now
Refresh
rule.level
rule.id
10
5763
Expanded document
View surrounding documents
View single document
Table
JSON
_index
wazuh-alerts-4.x-2026.03.24
agent.id
000
agent.name
wazuh-server
data.dstuser
tirthak
data.srcip
192.168.1.7
data.srcport
46606
decoder.name
sshd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.14","AC.7"],"pci_dss":["11.4","10.2.4","10.2.5"],"tsc":["CC6.1","CC6.8","CC7.2","CC7.3"]},"agent":{"id":"000","name":"w
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ewall-drop"}}
2026/03/24 04:33:59 active-response/bin/firewall-drop: Ended
tirthak@wazuh-server:~$
DQL
~ 15 minutes
rule.level
10
Expanded document
Table
JSON
_index
wazuh-alerts-4.x-2026.03.24
agent.id
000
agent.name
wazuh-server
data.dstuser
tirthak
data.srcip
192.168.1.7